

Governance Cadence and Stakeholder Reporting Framework

Maximus UK

Operational governance | KPI reporting | RAID management | Data quality controls | Stakeholder cadence

Company context	Maximus UK - operational services, reporting and performance environment
Role positioning	Data analytics, business analysis and governance contributor
Framework type	Stakeholder reporting, governance cadence, RAID and decision-management framework
Use case	Portfolio/interview artefact based on previous implementation experience

Document positioning

This document is written as a previous-role example, showing a practical governance and reporting framework I implemented at Maximus UK. It is not presented as a theoretical interview exercise; it is structured as a reusable working model for operational performance, analytics and stakeholder management.

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1. Purpose and Background

I developed and implemented this governance cadence and stakeholder reporting framework during my previous role at Maximus UK to bring more structure, consistency and accountability into operational reporting, performance reviews and management updates.

The purpose was to move the business away from ad-hoc updates, manual status chasing and disconnected reporting conversations, and towards a controlled governance model where performance, risks, issues, dependencies, actions and decisions were reviewed through a clear cadence.

The framework gave stakeholders a reliable view of what was happening across operations, analytics, reporting and service delivery. It also created a consistent mechanism for escalation, decision-making and follow-up.

2. Business Context

At Maximus UK, reporting and governance involved multiple stakeholder groups, including operational leads, performance teams, business analysts, data and reporting teams, senior management and delivery teams.

The environment required regular visibility of:

- Operational performance against agreed KPIs and service measures.
- Data quality issues affecting reporting accuracy and confidence.
- Risks, issues, assumptions, dependencies and decisions affecting delivery.
- Action ownership across business, analytics and operational teams.
- Trends, exceptions and performance movements requiring management attention.
- Clear escalation routes for items requiring senior-level decisions.

Before the framework was formalised, some updates were being handled through separate conversations, spreadsheets, meetings and email trails. This made it difficult to maintain a single version of the truth, track ownership consistently and give senior stakeholders a clean summary of what required action.

3. Framework Objectives

1. Create one structured reporting rhythm across operational, analytical and management stakeholders.
2. Improve visibility of performance, risks, issues and dependencies through a consistent management pack.
3. Reduce manual follow-up by assigning clear owners, due dates and escalation routes.
4. Improve data quality and reporting confidence by introducing checks before reports were shared.
5. Support faster decision-making by separating operational updates from executive-level decisions.
6. Create a reusable governance model that could be applied across reporting, transformation and operational improvement workstreams.

4. Governance Cadence

I structured the governance cadence across daily, weekly, monthly and exception-based review layers. Each layer had a defined audience, purpose, input and output.

Cadence layer	Purpose	Primary audience	Core outputs
Daily / operational check-in	Review immediate operational exceptions, reporting blockers, data issues and urgent actions.	Operational leads, reporting analysts, business analysts and delivery owners.	Updated action log, issue log and escalation list.
Weekly performance and governance review	Review KPI movement, trend, exceptions, RAID items, actions and delivery dependencies.	Operations managers, performance leads, data/reporting teams, PMO or governance representatives.	Weekly governance pack, updated RAID log, decision log and action tracker.
Monthly management review	Provide senior stakeholders with a consolidated view of performance, risk, data quality and improvement activity.	Senior managers, operational leadership, reporting leads and business sponsors.	Monthly management pack, executive summary, escalations and decisions.

Cadence layer	Purpose	Primary audience	Core outputs
Exception-based escalation	Escalate critical items immediately rather than waiting for the next scheduled meeting.	Relevant senior owner, workstream lead and impacted stakeholder group.	Escalation summary, owner assignment and agreed resolution path.

4.1 Daily / Operational Check-in

The daily check-in was focused on immediate exceptions and short-cycle action management. It was not designed to become a lengthy meeting; the purpose was to identify what had changed, what was blocked and what needed escalation.

- Daily KPI exceptions and unusual movement.
- Data refresh failures or reporting delays.
- High-priority operational issues.
- Actions due or overdue from the previous day.
- Items requiring escalation into weekly governance.

4.2 Weekly Performance and Governance Review

The weekly review was the main governance checkpoint. It gave stakeholders a structured view of KPI performance, trend movement, risks, issues, dependencies, decisions and actions.

- Weekly KPI performance and movement against previous week or baseline.
- Reporting exceptions and root-cause commentary.
- Open risks, issues and dependencies.
- Decisions required from management.
- Actions due, overdue, blocked or completed.

4.3 Monthly Management Review

The monthly review consolidated the most important updates for senior stakeholders. It focused on performance trends, business impact, aged risks, escalations and decisions requiring sponsorship.

- Month-to-date and month-end KPI performance.
- Variance analysis and trend commentary.
- Data quality observations and limitations.
- Risk and issue ageing.
- Open dependencies affecting delivery.
- Progress against improvement initiatives.

4.4 Exception-Based Escalation

I also included exception-based escalation triggers so critical items were not left waiting for the next formal meeting.

Escalation trigger	Example
KPI deterioration beyond tolerance	Performance dropped materially below the agreed threshold or baseline.
Repeated data quality failure	Recurring incomplete, missing, duplicate or inconsistent records affected reporting confidence.
Missed SLA or reporting deadline	A required management report or operational output was delayed.
Blocked dependency	Progress depended on another team, system owner, supplier or stakeholder.
Decision required	A management decision was needed before delivery could continue.
Potential business impact	Risk had possible service, financial, compliance or operational consequences.

5. Stakeholder Reporting Structure

The stakeholder reporting model was designed so that each audience received the right level of detail. Operational stakeholders needed action-focused detail; management needed trends and impact; senior leadership needed concise decisions and escalation points.

Stakeholder group	Reporting need	Typical questions answered
Operational stakeholders	Detailed, action-focused reporting covering movements, exceptions, blockers and ownership.	What changed? Where is the issue? Who owns the action? What needs to be fixed? Is the issue recurring?
Management stakeholders	Summarised view of performance, trends, risks, business impact and decisions.	What is the trend? What are the main risks? What decisions are required? Are actions progressing on time?
Executive / senior leadership	Concise view of overall status, material risks, service impact and required decisions.	What needs attention? What is the impact? What decision or sponsorship is required? What is the confidence level?

6. Reporting Pack Design

I designed the stakeholder reporting pack to avoid lengthy narrative and focus on evidence-based management information. The pack was structured to show performance, explain movement, highlight exceptions and drive decisions.

Pack section	Purpose
Executive summary	Short summary of overall status, key movements, risks and decisions required.
KPI performance overview	Performance against agreed KPIs, including trend, variance and RAG status.
Exception analysis	Commentary on underperformance, unusual movement or operational anomalies.
Data quality summary	Issues affecting reporting accuracy, completeness or timeliness.
RAID summary	Risks, assumptions, issues and dependencies with ownership and status.
Action tracker	Open, overdue, completed and blocked actions.
Decision log	Decisions made, pending decisions and decision owners.
Forward look	Upcoming reporting milestones, known risks and expected activities.

7. RAID, Action and Decision Management

A key part of the framework was the use of a structured RAID and action-management process. This gave the governance meetings discipline and made sure each item had a clear owner, due date, status and next action.

Category	Definition in the framework
Risk	A potential future event that could affect delivery, reporting accuracy, service performance or stakeholder confidence.
Assumption	Something being treated as true for planning or reporting purposes, but requiring validation.
Issue	A current problem already affecting delivery, performance, reporting or operations.
Dependency	An item reliant on another team, system, process, supplier or stakeholder before progress could continue.
Decision	An item requiring management or stakeholder agreement before action could proceed.
Action	A specific task assigned to an owner with a due date and expected outcome.

8. Ownership and Accountability Model

Each item in the governance framework had a named owner, due date and status. This avoided vague updates and helped keep management discussions focused on progress, blockers and decisions.

Field	Description
Reference ID	Unique identifier used for tracking and cross-referencing.
Category	Risk, assumption, issue, dependency, decision or action.
Description	Clear explanation of the item and what is affected.
Business impact	Operational, service, financial, reporting or stakeholder impact.
Owner	Named person accountable for progress.
Supporting team	Team or function supporting resolution.
Due date	Target completion or review date.
Current status	Open, in progress, blocked, closed or deferred.
RAG rating	Green, Amber, Red or Grey based on status criteria.
Latest update	Most recent progress note.

Field	Description
Next action	Specific next step required.
Escalation required	Yes / No flag showing whether management intervention is required.

9. RAG Status Criteria

The framework used simple RAG logic so stakeholders could quickly understand status. The purpose of RAG was not just colour coding; it was used to drive action, escalation and decision-making.

Status	Meaning
Green	On track, no immediate management intervention required.
Amber	At risk; action required to prevent delay or performance impact.
Red	Off track, blocked, overdue or requiring escalation.
Grey	Not started, paused or awaiting dependency.

10. Data Quality Controls

Because reporting was used for operational and management decisions, I included data quality checks as part of the governance process. The aim was to separate true performance movement from data-quality movement and improve stakeholder confidence in the reports.

- Checked report refresh completion before distribution.
- Validated KPI totals against source data or agreed control totals.
- Reviewed missing, duplicate or inconsistent records.
- Highlighted reporting gaps or incomplete fields.
- Separated genuine operational movement from data-quality issues.
- Captured known data limitations in reporting commentary.

11. Tools and Artefacts Used

Artefact / tool	How it supported the framework
Power BI	Dashboarding, KPI reporting, trend analysis and performance views.
Excel	Structured RAID logs, action trackers, decision logs and validation workbooks.
SharePoint / Teams	Document control, version history, governance packs and stakeholder access.
SQL / data extracts	Source-level validation, data checks and root-cause investigation.
PowerPoint	Senior stakeholder reporting packs and concise management summaries.
Planner / task tools	Action follow-up where work needed structured ownership and completion tracking.
KPI dictionary	Common definitions, calculation logic and reporting interpretation.
Reporting timetable	Clear schedule for refreshes, reviews, pack production and stakeholder updates.
Data quality checklist	Pre-distribution controls before management reports were shared.

12. Example Operating Flow

The model worked as a closed-loop governance process rather than a one-way reporting exercise.

1. Data was refreshed and validated before reporting.
2. KPI movements and exceptions were reviewed by the analytics or reporting team.
3. Issues, risks and dependencies were added or updated in the RAID log.
4. The weekly reporting pack was prepared with commentary and RAG status.

5. Stakeholders reviewed performance, risks and actions in the weekly governance meeting.
6. Decisions and escalations were captured in the decision log.
7. Owners updated actions before the next governance cycle.
8. Senior management received a summarised version during the monthly review.

13. Benefits Delivered

The framework improved the way reporting and governance were managed by making stakeholder conversations more consistent, evidence-based and action-focused.

- More consistent stakeholder reporting across operational and management audiences.
- Clearer ownership of actions, risks, issues and dependencies.
- Better visibility of operational performance trends and exceptions.
- Faster escalation of blocked items and material risks.
- Improved confidence in KPI reporting through stronger data quality checks.
- Reduced reliance on informal email follow-ups and separate trackers.
- Stronger link between data analysis, operational action and management decision-making.
- Reusable governance model that could be adapted across different reporting or transformation workstreams.

Value delivered

The main value was that reporting became more action-focused. Instead of simply showing numbers, the framework helped stakeholders understand what changed, why it mattered, who owned the next step and whether management intervention was required.

Repository Description

A previous-role governance framework developed at Maximus UK to structure stakeholder reporting, KPI reviews, RAID management, action tracking, decision logs and escalation routines across operational and analytics workstreams.